INCH-POUND
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SUPERSEDING
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COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

LIFE PRESERVER, ABANDON SHIP

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description by all federal agencies.

1. SCOPE. This commercial item description (CID) covers requirements for an abandon ship life preserver for use on U.S. Navy surface ships by personnel conducting abandon ship or amphibious troop operations only.

2. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

2.1 Performance characteristics. The abandon ship life preserver shall meet type III personal flotation device (PFD) requirements in accordance with 46 CFR § 160.076 and UL 1180, which includes all physical material components, buoyancy and flotation characteristics, and marking requirements. The inflatable bladder shall provide a minimum of 33 pounds of buoyancy and support the head.

2.2 Design and construction. The abandon ship life preserver shall be an inflatable preserver comprised of a waist belt with an attached pouch and an accessories pocket. The waist belt shall be adjustable and secured by a side release buckle (see figures 1 and 2). Unless otherwise specified herein, all measurement tolerances shall be ±¼ inch.

2.2.1 Outer shell material. The life preserver pouch and accessories pocket shall be the color Navy blue or black and fabricated from material in accordance with 46 CFR § 160.076 and UL 1191. The cloth shall have the following characteristics:

a. Minimum breaking strength of 150 pounds in the warp and filling when tested in accordance with ASTM D5034.

b. Minimum tongue tear of 9½ pounds in each direction when tested in accordance with ASTM D2261.

c. Minimum yarn slippage of 66 pounds in the warp and filling when tested in accordance with UL 1191.

d. Minimum seam strength of 70 pounds in the warp and filling when tested in accordance with ASTM D1683/D1683M.

2.2.2 Bladder material. The material for the bladder shall be sealable polyurethane-coated nylon cloth in the color yellow and in accordance with UL 1191.

2.2.3 Bladder tie straps. The bladder shall have two nylon, polyester, or polypropylene webbing tie straps at the upper chest/neck to secure the bladder when inflated. Each strap shall be a minimum of ¾ inch in width by 12 inches minimum in length.

2.2.4 Bladder markings. The bladder shall have a marking identifying the cylinder size (33 grams) and the method for folding and repackaging the bladder within the pouch.

2.2.5 Waist belt. The waist belt shall be minimum 1½-inch wide nylon, polyester, or polypropylene webbing with a slide adjuster and secured with a side buckle closure.

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FSC 4220

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2.2.6 Sizing. The vest waist shall be a universal size (30 to 52 inches).

2.2.7 Vest pouch. The vest pouch shall contain the following:

a. Over-the-head inflatable bladder with tie straps (see 6.3)
b. 33-gram CO_2 cylinder (see 6.3)
c. Manual inflator (see 6.3)

2.2.8 Accessories pocket. The pocket shall accommodate the required accessories and their accessory attachment cords and have a pocket flap secured by hook-and-loop tape. The pocket shall contain the following:

a. Distress marker light (see 6.3)
b. Flat whistle (see 6.3)
c. Buddy line with toggle (see 6.3)

2.2.9 Accessories securing cords. The distress marker light and flat whistle shall be secured to the accessories pocket with a nominal 1/16-inch diameter nylon, polyester, or polypropylene cord having a minimum tensile strength of 90 pounds. The cord shall be 24 inches in length for the flat whistle and 48 inches in length for the distress marker light. Cord length tolerance shall be ±2 inches. The buddy line shall be a nominal 1/8-inch diameter cord or 1/2-inch tubular webbing, nylon, polyester, or polypropylene and 48 inches (±2 inches) long in finished length. It shall have a hold-strength of 90 pounds for 10 seconds and maximum breaking strength of 300 pounds. The toggle shall be plastic and approximately 2½ inches long.

2.2.10 Distress marker light patch. The upper-left section (shoulder area) of the bladder shall contain a minimum 1½- by 1½-inch nylon loop tape patch to temporarily attach the distress marker light in man overboard situations (see figure 2). The distress marker light shall have a ¾- by 1¾-inch nylon hook tape patch adhered permanently to the back of the light.

2.2.11 Alternative distress marker light attachment means. Unless the distress marker light is included in the accessories pocket as described in step 2.2.8, the distress marker light shall be permanently secured to nylon loop tape on the upper-left section of the life preserver by the means of plastic clip to 1½-inch strip fabric. The 1½- by 1½-inch nylon loop tape patch is secured to a strip of fabric measuring a finished length of 6¾ to 7¼ inches by 1½ inches sewn to the bladder under the binding on one side and the outside the welding seam on the other side of the bladder (see figure 3).

2.2.12 Distress marker light patch attachment tensile test. The light patch fabric strip attached to the upper-left section of the bladder shall withstand a 25-pound load applied for 2 minutes. There shall be no damage to the bladder or light holder fabric strip (see figure 3).

2.2.13 Labeling. In addition to the labels and marking required by the Code of Federal Regulations, there shall be a label marked with the manufacturer name, vest model number, and National Stock Number (NSN).

2.3 Environmental requirements. All components shall be Underwriters Laboratories (UL) recognized for use in PFDs and shall meet the requirements for accelerated weathering in accordance with UL 1191.

3. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS. Recycled, recovered, environmentally preferable, or biobased materials should be used to the maximum extent possible, provided that the material meets or exceeds the operational and maintenance requirements, and promotes economically advantageous life cycle costs.

4. PRODUCT CONFORMANCE PROVISIONS. The products provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this commercial item description, conform to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and be the same product offered for sale in the commercial marketplace. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

5. PACKAGING. Preservation, packing, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

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6. NOTES.

6.1 Source of documents.

6.1.1 ASTM Standards. ASTM standards are available from www.astm.org or ASTM International, 100 Barr Harbor Dr., P.O. Box C700, West Conshohocken, PA 19428-2959.

6.1.2 Code of Federal Regulations (CFR). The CFR is available from www.ecfr.gov or the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Publishing Office, Washington, DC 20401.

6.1.3 UL Standards. UL standards are available from www.ul.com or COMM 2000, 151 Eastern Avenue, Bensenville, IL 60106.

6.2 Ordering data. The contract or order should specify the following:

a. CID document number and revision.
b. NSNs.
c. Product conformance provisions.
d. Quantity required.
e. Packaging requirements.

6.3 National stock numbers (NSN). The following is a list of NSNs assigned that correspond to this CID. The list may not be indicative of all possible NSNs associated with the CID.

NSN	Item
4220-01-487-2932	Life Preserver, Abandon Ship
4220-01-493-5995	Manual Inflator Mechanism
4220-01-562-5488	33-Gram CO_2 Cylinder
6230-01-686-4184	Distress Marker Light
4220-01-487-2931	Flat Whistle

6.4 Key words.

Personal Flotation Device

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FIGURE 1. Abandon ship life preserver vest pouch and accessories pocket.



FIGURE 2. Bladder and accessories.

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FIGURE 3. Stearns bladder and accessories.

CONCLUDING MATERIAL

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:
Navy – SH
Air Force – 03

Review Activities:
Navy – AS
Air Force – 11, 184

Preparing Activity:
Navy – SH
(Project 4220-2022-003)

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